



SURVEY SHARK

Field Collector Guide

For student researchers collecting survey responses

For students collecting data for a research unit fieldwork exercise.
Keep this guide with you (or saved on your phone) during data collection.

Fill this in before you go to the field

Web address to open	
Access code	
My Student Researcher ID	
Supervisor contact	

Ask your supervisor for these before your first day of fieldwork.

1. What is Survey Shark?

Survey Shark is the app you'll use on your phone to enter each participant's survey answers while you're out doing fieldwork. It replaces a paper questionnaire — it asks the same questions, in the same order, and works even when you have no internet signal.

Why it works without signal

Once you've opened the app one time with data or wifi, it keeps working with no signal at all. Answers you enter are saved on your phone first, then sent to the research team automatically the next time you have a connection — you don't need to do anything for this to happen.

2. Before you go out

Make sure you have:

- Your **Student Researcher ID** (given to you by your supervisor)
- The **Access Code** for the study (given to you by your supervisor)

- A phone with a web browser (Chrome or Safari) and, just for the very first setup, mobile data or wifi
- Signed paper consent forms and Participant Information Sheets, as per your normal fieldwork procedure

Privacy reminder

Do not type a participant's name, phone number, Facebook username, profile link, password, private messages, or exact home address into the app at any point. The questionnaire is designed to need none of this — if a question ever seems to ask for it, skip it and continue.

3. One-time setup (needs internet)

Do this once per phone, before your first day of fieldwork — you won't need to repeat it.

- 1 Open your browser and go to the web address your supervisor gave you.
- 2 Tap the survey you'll be collecting for.
- 3 Enter the **Access Code** and your **Student Researcher ID** exactly as given to you, then tap **Continue**.
- 4 Recommended: use your browser's "Add to Home Screen" option so the app opens like a normal app and reminds you it's there.

"Student researcher ID not recognised"

Double-check spelling and capitalisation with your supervisor — IDs are matched exactly. If it still doesn't work, contact your supervisor before continuing.

4. Collecting a response

Repeat this for every participant you interview:

- 1 Confirm the participant has read the Participant Information Sheet and signed the paper consent form, as per your normal fieldwork procedure.
- 2 Open the survey in the app and work through each section, tapping the answer that best matches what the participant tells you.
- 3 Tap **Next** to move to the next section. Required questions are marked with a red asterisk (*) and must be answered before you can continue.
- 4 On the last section, tap **Submit**.
- 5 Tap **Start next participant** to reset the form and begin the next interview.

A participant may be screened out — this is normal

The first few questions check whether someone is eligible (18+, uses Facebook, lives/works/studies in Honiara, and has agreed to take part). If they answer "No" to any of these, the app will end the survey automatically and show a thank-you message. This is expected — simply thank the person and move on to your next participant. It still counts as a recorded attempt.

5. Working without signal

A small bar at the top of the screen shows your connection status and how many completed responses are still waiting to be sent:

- **Online** (green dot) — responses are sending automatically.
- **Offline — saving locally** (amber dot) — keep working normally. Nothing is lost; it will send itself once you're back in signal.
- A number like **"3 waiting to sync"** means 3 completed responses are stored on your phone, ready to send.

At the end of each day

Open the app once while you have signal (e.g. back at your accommodation) and check the status bar shows "0 waiting to sync" before you close it for the night. You can also tap **Sync now** to force it to try immediately.

6. Your target

You are asked to collect **10 completed responses**. Keep your own tally (paper or phone notes) as you go — your supervisor can also see your progress on their dashboard, but it may take a moment to update after you sync.

7. Troubleshooting

Problem	What to do
"Incorrect access code"	Re-check the code with your supervisor — it is case-sensitive.
"Student researcher ID not recognised"	Confirm the exact spelling/format of your ID with your supervisor.
App looks blank or stuck	Close and reopen the browser tab. You only need signal for the very first setup, not for collecting responses.
Accidentally closed the app mid-survey	The in-progress (unsubmitted) response is lost. Start that participant again from the beginning — already-submitted responses are unaffected.
Not sure if a response actually saved	Check the sync status bar at the top of the screen — it shows how many are waiting or already synced.
Anything else	Contact your supervisor using the details on the front page of this guide.

Tagio tumas — thank you for helping with this research.